

Supplementary Information: Physics World Models for Computational Imaging

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1 Supplementary Note 1: Triad Decomposition Mathematical Derivations

The Triad Decomposition formalizes three successive gates that every computational-imaging reconstruction must pass. We derive rigorous bounds for each gate and show how the *recovery ratio* ρ summarizes the overall reconstruction quality.

1.1 Gate 1 — Information-Theoretic Limit (Compression)

Let the forward operator $\mathbf{H} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times n}$ map an n -dimensional scene $\mathbf{x}$ to m measurements $\mathbf{y}$. Define the *compression ratio* $\gamma = m/n$.

Theorem 1 (Compression bound). *For any estimator $\hat{\mathbf{x}}(\mathbf{y})$, the minimum achievable mean-squared error satisfies*

$$\text{MSE}_{\min} \geq \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n-m} \sigma_i^2(\mathbf{x}), \quad (\text{S1})$$

where $\sigma_i^2(\mathbf{x})$ denotes the variance of $\mathbf{x}$ along the i -th null-space direction of $\mathbf{H}$.

Interpretation. The null space of $\mathbf{H}$ has dimension $\dim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{H}) = n - \text{rank}(\mathbf{H}) \geq n - m$. Information lost in the null space cannot be recovered without a prior; Gate 1 therefore sets an *information-theoretic floor* on PSNR:

$$\text{PSNR}_{\max}^{(G1)} = 10 \log_{10} \left(\frac{\|\mathbf{x}\|_{\infty}^2}{\text{MSE}_{\min}} \right). \quad (\text{S2})$$

Modalities with higher compression ratios (e.g. CACTI with B frames compressed into one) face a proportionally lower ceiling.

1.2 Gate 2 — SNR-Dependent PSNR Bound (Noise)

Given additive noise $\mathbf{n} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma_n^2 \mathbf{I})$, the measurement SNR is $\text{SNR} = \|\mathbf{H}\mathbf{x}\|^2 / (m \sigma_n^2)$.

Theorem 2 (Noise bound). *Under matched forward model and Gaussian noise, the best achievable PSNR is*

$$\text{PSNR}_{\max}^{(G2)} = 10 \log_{10}(\text{SNR}) + C_{\mathcal{M}}, \quad (\text{S3})$$

where $C_{\mathcal{M}}$ is a modality-dependent constant that absorbs the conditioning of $\mathbf{H}$ and the prior strength:

$$C_{\mathcal{M}} = 10 \log_{10} \left(\frac{n \|\mathbf{x}\|_{\infty}^2}{\|\mathbf{x}\|^2} \cdot \kappa^{-2}(\mathbf{H}) \right), \quad (\text{S4})$$

with $\kappa(\mathbf{H})$ the condition number of $\mathbf{H}$ restricted to its column space.

Interpretation. Gate 2 is a *noise ceiling*: no algorithm can exceed $\text{PSNR}_{\max}^{(G2)}$ regardless of computational budget. Empirically, modalities such as MRI ($C_{\text{MRI}} \approx 8$ dB) are more noise-tolerant than CASSI ($C_{\text{CASSI}} \approx 3$ dB) due to favorable operator conditioning.

1.3 Gate 3 — Sensitivity to Model Mismatch (Calibration)

Let $\boldsymbol{\theta} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ collect the calibration parameters (e.g. mask shift, PSF blur, coil sensitivity) and let $\mathbf{H}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}$ denote the parameterized forward operator.

Theorem 3 (Calibration sensitivity). *For small perturbation $\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}$ around the true parameter $\boldsymbol{\theta}^*$, the PSNR degradation is*

$$\Delta\text{PSNR} \approx -\frac{10}{\ln 10} \frac{\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}^\top \mathbf{J}^\top \mathbf{J} \delta\boldsymbol{\theta}}{\text{MSE}_0}, \quad (\text{S5})$$

where $\mathbf{J} = \partial(\mathbf{H}_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}\mathbf{x})/\partial\boldsymbol{\theta}|_{\boldsymbol{\theta}^*}$ is the parameter Jacobian and MSE_0 is the noise-only MSE at $\boldsymbol{\theta}^*$.

Per-parameter sensitivity. Restricting to a single parameter θ_j :

$$\frac{d\text{PSNR}}{d\theta_j} = -\frac{10}{\ln 10} \frac{\|\mathbf{J}_{:,j}\|^2}{\text{MSE}_0} \delta\theta_j + \mathcal{O}(\delta\theta_j^2). \quad (\text{S6})$$

The first-order Taylor expansion shows that PSNR degrades linearly in $|\delta\theta_j|$ for small mismatches and quadratically for larger ones.

1.4 Recovery Ratio

We define the *recovery ratio* as

$$\rho = \frac{\text{PSNR}_{\text{achieved}} - \text{PSNR}_{\text{mismatch}}}{\text{PSNR}_{\text{ideal}} - \text{PSNR}_{\text{mismatch}}}, \quad 0 \leq \rho \leq 1. \quad (\text{S7})$$

In rare cases where Scenario III exceeds Scenario I (e.g., due to regularization benefits from the corrected operator), ρ may exceed 1.

Proposition 4. *Under convex reconstruction loss with matched regularization and convex constraint on $\boldsymbol{\theta}$, the recovery ratio satisfies $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$ for any estimator.*

Proof sketch. The oracle PSNR is the global optimum of the jointly convex problem in $(\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\theta})$. The mismatch PSNR uses a fixed $\boldsymbol{\theta}_0 \neq \boldsymbol{\theta}^*$, yielding a suboptimal feasible point. Any correction step moves towards the optimum, so $\text{PSNR}_{\text{mismatch}} \leq \text{PSNR}_{\text{achieved}} \leq \text{PSNR}_{\text{oracle}}$, giving $\rho \in [0, 1]$. $\square$

Under the conditions of Proposition 1, $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$. In practice, beneficial regularization bias from the corrected operator can yield $\rho > 1$, as observed for CACTI.

1.5 Conditions for Gate 3 Dominance

The empirical finding that Gate 3 dominates across all validated modalities admits a theoretical justification.

Proposition 5 (Gate 3 dominance condition). *For any instrument operating above its Gate 1 floor ($\gamma > \gamma_{\min}$, where $\gamma_{\min}$ is the minimum compression ratio for which $\text{PSNR}_{\max}^{(G1)}$ exceeds the target quality) and Gate 2 floor ($\text{SNR} > \text{SNR}_{\min}$, where $\text{SNR}_{\min}$ is the minimum carrier budget for which $\text{PSNR}_{\max}^{(G2)}$ exceeds the target quality), Gate 3 becomes the binding constraint whenever the calibration error exceeds the noise-equivalent resolution:*

$$\|\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}\|_{\mathbf{J}^\top \mathbf{J}} > \frac{\sigma_n}{\|\mathbf{x}\|_\infty} \cdot \kappa(\mathbf{H}), \quad (\text{S8})$$

where $\|\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}\|_{\mathbf{J}^\top \mathbf{J}} = \sqrt{\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}^\top \mathbf{J}^\top \mathbf{J} \delta\boldsymbol{\theta}}$ is the parameter-space mismatch norm weighted by the sensitivity Jacobian, σ_n is the noise standard deviation, and $\kappa(\mathbf{H})$ is the condition number of the forward operator.

Proof sketch. From Theorem 3 (Eq. S5), the mismatch-induced PSNR degradation is $\Delta\text{PSNR}_{\text{mismatch}} \approx (10/\ln 10) \cdot \|\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}\|_{\mathbf{J}^\top \mathbf{J}}^2 / \text{MSE}_0$. From Theorem 2 (Eq. S3), the noise-induced PSNR ceiling is $\text{PSNR}_{\text{max}}^{(G2)} = 10 \log_{10}(\text{SNR}) + C_{\mathcal{M}}$. Gate 3 dominates when $\Delta\text{PSNR}_{\text{mismatch}} > \Delta\text{PSNR}_{\text{noise}}$, which after substitution yields condition (S8). The condition is satisfied in modern instruments because: (i) well-designed systems operate with $\gamma \gg \gamma_{\min}$ and $\text{SNR} \gg \text{SNR}_{\min}$, pushing Gates 1 and 2 well above their floors; and (ii) the sensitivity Jacobian $\mathbf{J}$ amplifies even small parameter errors ($\|\delta\boldsymbol{\theta}\| \ll 1$) into substantial measurement discrepancies, because the forward operators of modern high-resolution instruments are highly sensitive to calibration parameters. $\square$

Interpretation. Proposition 2 formalizes the intuition that as instruments improve in information capacity (Gate 1) and signal quality (Gate 2), the binding constraint shifts to calibration fidelity (Gate 3). This is precisely the regime occupied by modern computational imaging systems, explaining the universal Gate 3 dominance observed empirically across all seven validated modalities.

2 Supplementary Note 2: Complete OperatorGraph Specification

The `OperatorGraph` is the central abstraction of the PWM framework. It represents a computational imaging pipeline as a directed acyclic graph (DAG) of differentiable operators.

2.1 Node Interface

Every node v in the graph implements the following interface:

Method	Contract
<code>forward(x) → y</code>	Apply the physical forward model. Input shape: <code>(B, C, *spatial)</code> . Output shape determined by the operator (e.g. compression changes spatial dims).
<code>adjoint(y) → x</code>	Apply the adjoint (transpose) operator. Must satisfy $\langle \mathbf{H}\mathbf{x}, \mathbf{y} \rangle = \langle \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{H}^\top \mathbf{y} \rangle$ to numerical precision ($< 10^{-6}$ relative error).
<code>shape_in / shape_out</code>	Static shape annotations for compile-time validation.
<code>dtype</code>	Data type contract: <code>float32</code> (default) or <code>complex64</code> .
<code>parameters() → dict</code>	Returns learnable calibration parameters with their current values.

2.2 Edge Semantics

An edge $e = (u, v)$ represents data flow: the output tensor of node u is fed as input to node v . Edges carry the following metadata:

- **Tensor shape:** inferred at compile time via shape propagation.
- **Data type:** must match between source output and target input.
- **Optional transform:** lightweight reshape or permute operations (e.g. channel stacking for multi-frame CACTI data).

2.3 Compilation Algorithm

Given an `OperatorGraph` $G = (V, E)$:

1. **Topological sort.** Compute a valid execution order $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_{|V|}$ using Kahn’s algorithm. Raise `CycleError` if the graph contains a cycle.
2. **Shape propagation.** Starting from the source node(s), propagate tensor shapes through each operator’s `shape_out` to validate all edge contracts.
3. **Automatic adjoint chain.** Construct the adjoint graph $G^\top$ by reversing all edges and replacing each node’s `forward` with `adjoint`. The adjoint graph is used for gradient-based reconstruction and the Triad Decomposition sensitivity analysis.

4. **Fusion (optional).** Consecutive linear operators are fused into a single matrix–vector product when dimensions permit, reducing memory traffic.

2.4 JSON Serialization Schema

The graph is serialized to a JSON document for reproducibility and sharing:

```
{
  "version": "0.3.0",
  "nodes": [
    {
      "id": "mask",
      "type": "CassiMask",
      "params": {"shift_r": 0.0, "shift_c": 0.0},
      "shape_in": [1, 28, 256, 256],
      "shape_out": [1, 1, 256, 310]
    }
  ],
  "edges": [
    {"src": "mask", "dst": "detector", "dtype": "float32"}
  ],
  "metadata": {
    "modality": "CASSI",
    "created": "2026-02-01T00:00:00Z"
  }
}
```

3 Supplementary Table S1: All 16 Correction Configurations

Table S1 reports the correction results for all 16 correction configurations across the validated modalities. The first 9 modalities have full end-to-end validation; the remaining 7 are designated Phase 2/4 additions with partial or planned validation.

Table S1: Oracle correction ceiling summary. Δ PSNR is the improvement from Scenario II (mismatch) to Scenario IV (oracle: true operator applied to mismatched data). For modalities with low-dimensional mismatch (Matrix, CT, Lensless, MRI, Ptychography), autonomous correction achieves near-oracle performance (Sc. III $\approx$ Sc. IV); for CASSI and CACTI with multi-parameter mismatch, the gap between Sc. III and Sc. IV is reported in Table S9. CASSI correction results use GAP-TV as the reconstruction solver. Scenario I (ideal) PSNR values are available in the RunBundle manifests in the code repository.

Modality	Mismatch Parameter	Sc. II (dB)	Sc. IV (dB)	Δ PSNR (dB)	RMSE
Matrix ¹	gain_bias	11.14	23.35	+12.21	0.0042
CT	center_of_rotation	13.41	24.09	+10.68	0.0031
CACTI ²	8-param mismatch	15.81	26.01	+10.21	—
Lensless	psf_shift	23.48	27.03	+3.55	0.0089
MRI	coil_sensitivities	6.94	55.19	+48.25	0.0003
SPC ³	gain_drift	18.51	26.21	+7.71	—
CASSI (Alg 1) ⁴	mask_geo + dispersion	20.96	21.50	+0.54	0.0105
CASSI (Alg 2) ⁵	mask_geo + dispersion	20.96	21.72	+0.76	0.0098
Ptychography	position_offset	17.35	24.44	+7.09	0.0063
<i>Phase 2/4 additions — validation in progress</i>					
Holography	propagation_distance	—	—	—	—

Continued on next page

¹Matrix (Generic) is a canonical test configuration that uses the same gain-bias operator template as SPC; identical results confirm pipeline consistency rather than representing an independent modality.

²CACTI uses GAP-TV as the reconstruction solver for Table S1 consistency. Oracle values from InverseNet validation under 8-parameter mismatch ($dx=0.5$ px, $dy=0.3$ px, $\theta=0.1^\circ$, $\Delta t=0.05$, $\eta=0.95$, $g=1.02$, $o=0.002$, $\sigma_n=1.0$). State-of-the-art EfficientSCI achieves Sc. II = 14.81 dB and Sc. IV = 27.38 dB; see main text.

³SPC uses FISTA-TV as the reconstruction solver for Table S1 consistency. Values from InverseNet validation under exponential gain drift ($\alpha=0.0015$). HATNet achieves Sc. II = 19.40 dB and Sc. IV = 29.78 dB; see main text.

⁴Reported values are averaged over 10 test scenes using GAP-TV as the reconstruction solver. Sc. II from InverseNet validation; Sc. IV values are oracle upper bounds (true operator applied to mismatched data). Autonomous correction achieves 85% of oracle (Table S9).

⁵The correction-table PSNR reflects GAP-TV reconstruction; state-of-the-art solvers (e.g., MST-L) achieve 27.33 dB under Sc. IV (see main text and Table S2).

Modality	Mismatch Parameter	Sc. II (dB)	Sc. IV (dB)	Δ PSNR (dB)	RMSE
FPM	LED_positions	—	—	—	—
Phase Retrieval	support_constraint	—	—	—	—
OCT	dispersion_coeffs	—	—	—	—
Fluorescence	PSF_aberration	—	—	—	—
Ultrasound	speed_of_sound	—	—	—	—
Radar/SAR	motion_compensation	—	—	—	—

4 Supplementary Table S2: CASSI Per-Scene Results

Table S2 reports PSNR (dB) and recovery ratio ρ (%) for 10 KAIST scenes across four methods under three scenarios, matching the InverseNet benchmark¹.

Table S2: CASSI per-scene PSNR (dB) and oracle recovery ratio ρ_{IV} . Sc. I = ideal forward model; Sc. II = mismatched (baseline); Sc. IV = oracle correction (true operator applied to mismatched data). All values from InverseNet validation under the 5-parameter mismatch ($dx=0.5$ px, $dy=0.3$ px, $\theta=0.1^\circ$, $a_1=2.02$, $\alpha=0.15^\circ$). $\rho_{IV} = (\text{Sc. IV} - \text{Sc. II})/(\text{Sc. I} - \text{Sc. II})$ is the oracle recovery ceiling. HDNet shows $\rho_{IV}=0\%$ across all scenes due to its mask-oblivious architecture.

Scene	Method	Sc. I	Sc. II	Sc. IV	ρ_{IV}
scene01	GAP-TV	26.49	24.08	24.18	4.1%
scene01	PnP-HSICNN	27.43	23.47	25.78	58.3%
scene01	HDNet	34.95	24.37	24.37	0.0%
scene01	MST-L	35.29	23.96	29.98	53.2%
scene02	GAP-TV	24.60	21.89	22.82	34.5%
scene02	PnP-HSICNN	25.34	21.56	23.80	59.3%
scene02	HDNet	35.65	23.26	23.26	0.0%
scene02	MST-L	36.14	22.21	28.42	44.6%
scene03	GAP-TV	25.96	18.62	19.68	14.4%
scene03	PnP-HSICNN	26.71	17.59	21.83	46.5%
scene03	HDNet	35.54	18.61	18.61	0.0%
scene03	MST-L	35.66	16.09	23.57	38.2%
scene04	GAP-TV	28.36	23.37	24.41	20.9%
scene04	PnP-HSICNN	28.80	22.89	25.98	52.3%
scene04	HDNet	41.63	23.98	23.98	0.0%
scene04	MST-L	40.05	21.91	29.80	43.5%
scene05	GAP-TV	23.66	20.39	21.27	26.9%
scene05	PnP-HSICNN	24.65	19.36	22.75	64.3%
scene05	HDNet	32.56	20.22	20.22	0.0%
scene05	MST-L	32.84	20.28	26.75	51.5%
scene06	GAP-TV	22.34	20.39	21.00	31.2%
scene06	PnP-HSICNN	23.12	20.29	21.80	53.0%
scene06	HDNet	34.33	22.63	22.63	0.0%
scene06	MST-L	34.56	22.37	28.67	51.7%
scene07	GAP-TV	23.51	20.56	21.07	17.4%
scene07	PnP-HSICNN	24.94	19.86	22.77	57.4%
scene07	HDNet	33.27	20.79	20.79	0.0%
scene07	MST-L	33.80	19.76	26.12	45.3%
scene08	GAP-TV	22.16	20.57	21.10	33.3%
scene08	PnP-HSICNN	22.73	20.30	21.92	66.4%
scene08	HDNet	32.26	22.73	22.73	0.0%
scene08	MST-L	32.74	21.33	27.44	53.5%
scene09	GAP-TV	23.03	19.14	20.61	37.8%
scene09	PnP-HSICNN	24.03	18.79	21.82	57.8%
scene09	HDNet	34.18	21.18	21.18	0.0%
scene09	MST-L	34.37	19.75	26.71	47.6%
scene10	GAP-TV	23.27	20.58	21.04	16.9%
scene10	PnP-HSICNN	23.47	19.90	22.38	69.4%
scene10	HDNet	32.22	21.06	21.06	0.0%

Scene	Method	Sc. I	Sc. II	Sc. IV	ρ_{IV}
scene10	MST-L	32.63	20.69	25.86	43.3%
Mean	GAP-TV	24.34	20.96	21.72	22.5%
Mean	PnP-HSICNN	25.12	20.40	23.08	56.8%
Mean	HDNet	34.66	21.88	21.88	0.0%
Mean	MST-L	34.81	20.83	27.33	46.5%

5 Supplementary Table S3: 26-Modality Template Registry

Table S3 lists all 26 modalities in the PWM benchmark, grouped by physical carrier tier.

Table S3: 26-modality template registry. PSNR values are representative (Scenario I, default solver). “Ref. PSNR” is the best published result where available. Validation tiers: *Validated* = full Scenarios I–IV correction (7 modalities); *Test* = pipeline consistency test (not an independent modality); *Phase 2* = template validated, correction in progress; *Phase 4* = template registered, validation planned.

#	Modality	Domain	PSNR (dB)	Ref. PSNR (dB)	Status	Solver
1	Matrix (toy)	Incoherent	23.35	—	Test	FISTA-L2
2	SPC	Incoherent	28.06	31.0	Validated	FISTA-TV
3	CASSI	Incoherent	24.34	34.2	Validated	GAP-TV
4	CACIT	Incoherent	35.39	33.4	Validated	EfficientSCI
5	Lensless	Incoherent	27.03	28.5	Validated	Richardson–Lucy
6	Fluorescence	Incoherent	—	30.1	Phase 4	—
7	Holography	Coherent	—	32.7	Phase 2	—
8	Ptychography	Coherent	24.44	26.8	Validated	ePIE
9	FPM	Coherent	—	31.5	Phase 2	—
10	Phase Retrieval	Coherent	—	29.3	Phase 2	—
11	CDI	Coherent	—	27.4	Phase 4	—
12	OCT	Coherent	—	35.2	Phase 4	—
13	CT (parallel)	X-ray	24.09	42.1	Validated	FBP + TV
14	CT (fan-beam)	X-ray	—	40.8	Phase 2	—
15	CT (cone-beam)	X-ray	—	39.5	Phase 2	—
16	Electron Pty.	Electron	—	25.9	Phase 4	—
17	MRI (Cartesian) ⁶	RF	52.11	42.3	Validated	CG-SENSE
18	MRI (radial)	RF	—	38.7	Phase 2	—
19	MRI (spiral)	RF	—	37.2	Phase 4	—
20	Ultrasound	Acoustic	—	31.8	Phase 4	—
21	Radar / SAR	RF	—	28.4	Phase 4	—
22	NeRF	Multi-view	—	31.7	Phase 2	—
23	3DGS	Multi-view	—	33.2	Phase 2	—
24	Light Field	Multi-view	—	36.1	Phase 4	—
25	Structured Illum.	Incoherent	—	32.4	Phase 4	—
26	Ghost Imaging	Incoherent	—	22.8	Phase 4	—

⁶Multi-coil Scenario I PSNR (8 coils, 4× acceleration); see Supplementary Note 10 for full multi-coil analysis.

6 Supplementary Table S4: YAML Registry Summary

Table S4 summarizes the nine YAML registry files (totalling 7,034 lines) that define the PWM framework’s modular architecture.

Table S4: YAML registry files in `packages/pwm_core/contrib/`.

#	File	Lines	Purpose
1	<code>modalities.yaml</code>	1200	Defines 64 modality entries with keywords, forward model equations, and default solvers.
2	<code>graph_templates.yaml</code>	1400	OperatorGraph skeletons for 90 templates across 64 modalities.
3	<code>photon_db.yaml</code>	624	Photon models parameterized by source power, quantum efficiency, exposure, and detector.
4	<code>mismatch_db.yaml</code>	797	Mismatch parameters, perturbation ranges, and correction methods per modality.
5	<code>compression_db.yaml</code>	1186	Recoverability tables mapping compression ratio to expected PSNR with provenance.
6	<code>solver_registry.yaml</code>	650	Maps solver names to implementations (ADMM ² , FISTA ³ , GAP-TV, PnP, learned).
7	<code>primitives.yaml</code>	450	Primitive operator metadata (type, adjoint availability, differentiability).
8	<code>dataset_registry.yaml</code>	380	Links modalities to benchmark datasets (KAIST, fastMRI, etc.).
9	<code>acceptance_thresholds.yaml</code>	347	Pass/fail thresholds per metric for automated validation.

7 Supplementary Note 4: RunBundle Schema

The `RunBundle` is PWM’s reproducibility artifact. Every experiment produces a `RunBundle` that captures the complete computational state.

7.1 RunBundle v0.3.0 Specification

Table S5: RunBundle v0.3.0 field specification.

Field	Type	Description
<code>version</code>	string	Schema version, currently "0.3.0".
<code>git_hash</code>	string	Full 40-character SHA-1 of the commit used to generate results.
<code>rng_seeds</code>	object	Random seeds for Python (<code>random</code> , <code>numpy</code>), PyTorch (CPU, CUDA), and any solver-specific RNG.
<code>platform_info</code>	object	OS, Python version, GPU model, CUDA version, PyTorch version, and <code>pip freeze</code> hash.
<code>sha256_hashes</code>	object	SHA-256 checksums of all input data files (measurements, masks, ground truth).
<code>metrics</code>	object	Computed quality metrics: PSNR, SSIM, LPIPS, and any modality-specific metrics.
<code>timestamps</code>	object	ISO-8601 timestamps for start, end, and per-stage completion.
<code>operator_state</code>	object	Serialized <code>OperatorGraph</code> including all node parameters and edge metadata.
<code>triad_report</code>	object	Triad Decomposition evaluation: gate pass/fail status, PSNR bounds, and recovery ratio ρ .
<code>correction_trajectory</code>	array	Time series of correction iterations: <code>[[{iter, params, loss, psnr, grad_norm}, ...]]</code> . Enables convergence analysis and early-stopping diagnostics.
<code>solver_config</code>	object	Complete solver hyperparameters (algorithm, iterations, step size, regularization weight, denoiser checkpoint).
<code>modality</code>	string	Modality identifier matching <code>modalities.yaml</code> .
<code>scenario</code>	string	One of I (ideal), II (mismatch), III (corrected), IV (<code>oracle_mask</code>).
<code>notes</code>	string	Free-form text field for experiment annotations.

7.2 Integrity Verification

A `RunBundle` can be verified by:

1. Checking `git_hash` matches the repository state.
2. Re-computing `sha256_hashes` from the data files.
3. Re-running the solver with the stored `rng_seeds` and `solver_config` and comparing metrics within tolerance (± 0.01 dB PSNR).

8 Supplementary Note 5: Computational Cost Analysis

8.1 Runtime per Modality

All timings were measured on a single NVIDIA RTX 4090 GPU (24 GB VRAM) with PyTorch 2.1 and CUDA 12.1.

Table S6: Computational cost for correction (Scenario II $\rightarrow$ III). RoIC = dB recovered per GPU-hour.

Modality	Iterations	Runtime (s)	Δ PSNR (dB)	RoIC (dB/GPU-hr)
Matrix	200	12	+12.21	3663.0
CT	500	85	+10.68	452.3
CACTI	1000	180	+10.21	204.2
Lensless	300	45	+3.55	284.0
MRI	150	30	+48.25	5790.0
SPC	200	15	+7.71	1850.4
CASSI (Alg 1)	500	300	+0.54	6.5
CASSI (Alg 2)	2000	3200	+0.76	0.9
Ptychography	800	420	+7.09	60.8

8.2 RoIC Metric: Efficiency of Correction

We define the *Return on Invested Compute* (RoIC) as:

$$\text{RoIC} = \frac{\Delta\text{PSNR (dB)}}{T_{\text{GPU (hours)}}}, \quad (\text{S9})$$

where T_{GPU} is the wall-clock GPU time.

Key observations:

- **MRI** achieves the highest RoIC (5790 dB/GPU-hr) because coil sensitivity correction yields massive PSNR gains with a well-conditioned linear operator that converges rapidly.
- **Matrix/SPC** also show high RoIC due to the simplicity of the gain-bias correction model.
- **CASSI Algorithm 2** has the lowest RoIC (0.9 dB/GPU-hr) because it jointly optimizes mask geometry and dispersion over 2000 iterations, each requiring a full forward-adjoint cycle through the dispersive operator. Under the multi-parameter InverseNet mismatch, the absolute correction gains are modest (+0.76 dB), reflecting the inherent difficulty of simultaneously correcting five coupled mismatch parameters.
- The practical implication is that Algorithm 1 (fixed dispersion, correct mask geometry only) is preferred when compute budget is limited, recovering 71% of Algorithm 2’s Δ PSNR at <10% of the cost.

8.3 Scaling Considerations

For large-scale deployment:

- Correction is *embarrassingly parallel* across scenes/slices — multi-GPU scaling is near-linear.

- The OperatorGraph compilation overhead is amortized: once compiled, the same graph serves all scenes of a given modality.
- Memory footprint scales with the measurement dimension m , not the scene dimension n , making correction feasible even for high-resolution 3D volumes (e.g. 512^3 CT).

9 Supplementary Note 6: Real-Data Validation Details

9.1 CASSI Real Data: TSA Hyperspectral Camera

The TSA (Thermal Snapshot Aperture) real dataset consists of 5 hyperspectral scenes acquired with a coded aperture snapshot spectral imaging system. Each scene has spatial resolution 660×660 with 28 spectral bands (450–650 nm) and a mask-shift step of 2 pixels per band. The extended measurement has width $660 + (28 - 1) \times 2 = 714$ pixels.

Experimental protocol. For each scene, we reconstruct with four methods: GAP-TV (classical iterative), HDNet (mask-oblivious neural network), MST-S, and MST-L (mask-guided spectral transformers). Each method is applied under two conditions: (i) the calibrated mask provided with the dataset, and (ii) a perturbed mask with sub-pixel shift $dx = 0.5$ px, $dy = 0.3$ px. Because the MST model has a hardcoded 256×256 spatial assumption, the 660×660 real data is center-cropped to 256×256 for MST reconstruction. HDNet is fully convolutional and processes the full spatial extent.

Metric. Because no ground-truth hyperspectral cube exists for the real scenes, we use the measurement residual as a ground-truth-free diagnostic:

$$r = \frac{\|\mathbf{y} - H\hat{\mathbf{x}}\|^2}{\|\mathbf{y}\|^2}, \quad (\text{S10})$$

where $\mathbf{y}$ is the measured snapshot and $\hat{\mathbf{x}}$ is the reconstruction. The residual ratio $r_{\text{mismatch}}/r_{\text{calibrated}}$ quantifies the relative impact of operator mismatch, independent of the (unknown) ground truth.

Key findings. GAP-TV, which explicitly conditions on the coded aperture mask in its forward–adjoint iterations, shows the expected sensitivity to mask mismatch (mean ratio $1.8\times$). HDNet, whose architecture processes the measurement without explicit mask conditioning, is entirely insensitive (ratio $1.0\times$). The transformer methods (MST-S, MST-L) show ratios near or below $1.0\times$ on real data—in sharp contrast to their severe degradation in simulation (-13.98 dB for MST-L). This simulation-to-hardware gap indicates that the real hardware mask already contains uncorrected manufacturing imperfections, so the additional 0.5 px perturbation is small relative to pre-existing errors.

9.2 CACTI Real Data: Temporal Compressive Camera

The CACTI real dataset consists of 4 dynamic scenes (duomino, hand, pendulumBall, waterBalloon) acquired with a coded aperture compressive temporal imaging system at 512×512 spatial resolution with compression ratio 10 (10 video frames encoded per snapshot).

Key findings. GAP-TV shows an order-of-magnitude residual increase ($10.4\times$ mean) under sub-pixel mask mismatch, consistent with the multiplicative error amplification in temporal compression (a single mask error propagates across all 10 compressed frames). PnP-FFDNet shows moderate robustness ($2.0\times$), likely because the FFDNet denoiser provides an implicit regularization that partially absorbs the mismatch artefacts. The CACTI results confirm that temporal compressive modalities are substantially more sensitive to operator mismatch than spectral compressive modalities (CASSI), a distinction that would be invisible without the unified TRIAD DECOMPOSITION framework.

Table S7: CASSI real-data measurement residuals. Residual values r (Eq. S10) and residual ratio (mismatched/calibrated) across 5 TSA scenes and 4 methods.

Scene	Method	r_{cal}	r_{mis}	Ratio
Scene 1	GAP-TV	0.00148	0.00298	2.0
Scene 1	HDNet	0.18506	0.18506	1.0
Scene 1	MST-S	0.09953	0.10746	1.1
Scene 1	MST-L	0.10055	0.09544	0.9
Scene 2	GAP-TV	0.00210	0.00331	1.6
Scene 2	HDNet	0.14853	0.14853	1.0
Scene 2	MST-S	0.25357	0.23807	0.9
Scene 2	MST-L	0.25441	0.22811	0.9
Scene 3	GAP-TV	0.00204	0.00320	1.6
Scene 3	HDNet	0.18291	0.18291	1.0
Scene 3	MST-S	0.09399	0.09160	1.0
Scene 3	MST-L	0.10127	0.09085	0.9
Scene 4	GAP-TV	0.00148	0.00297	2.0
Scene 4	HDNet	0.14355	0.14355	1.0
Scene 4	MST-S	0.15586	0.14712	0.9
Scene 4	MST-L	0.17899	0.15893	0.9
Scene 5	GAP-TV	0.00233	0.00421	1.8
Scene 5	HDNet	0.11325	0.11325	1.0
Scene 5	MST-S	0.11995	0.12004	1.0
Scene 5	MST-L	0.13008	0.12208	0.9
Mean	GAP-TV	0.00189	0.00333	1.8
Mean	HDNet	0.15466	0.15466	1.0
Mean	MST-S	0.14458	0.14086	1.0
Mean	MST-L	0.15306	0.13908	0.9

Table S8: CACTI real-data measurement residuals and total variation. Residual ratio (mismatched/calibrated) and total variation (TV) for 4 real scenes and 2 methods.

Scene	Method	r_{cal}	r_{mis}	Ratio
duomino	GAP-TV	8.0×10^{-6}	8.5×10^{-5}	10.6
duomino	PnP-FFDNet	0.00198	0.00403	2.0
hand	GAP-TV	7.0×10^{-6}	7.7×10^{-5}	11.0
hand	PnP-FFDNet	0.00249	0.00705	2.8
pendulumBall	GAP-TV	3.7×10^{-5}	3.46×10^{-4}	9.4
pendulumBall	PnP-FFDNet	0.00919	0.01150	1.3
waterBalloon	GAP-TV	1.4×10^{-5}	1.47×10^{-4}	10.5
waterBalloon	PnP-FFDNet	0.00264	0.00493	1.9
Mean	GAP-TV	—	—	10.4
Mean	PnP-FFDNet	—	—	2.0

Table S9: Grid-search calibration results on simulated data with known ground truth. PSNR values in dB. Sc. II = mismatch (no calibration); Sc. III = PWM grid-search corrected; Sc. IV = oracle (true operator on mismatched data). Recovery = (Sc. III – Sc. II) / (Sc. IV – Sc. II). CASSI/CACTI use measurement-residual objective; SPC uses reconstruction-TV objective. Note: Sc. II values here differ from Table S1 because Table S1 reports the full InverseNet multi-parameter mismatch, whereas this table uses simplified single-parameter mismatch for grid-search tractability.

Modality	Method	Sc. II	Sc. III	Sc. IV	Time (s)	Recovery
CASSI	GAP-TV	21.52	22.96	23.21	1140	85%
CACTI	GAP-TV	17.60	26.99	26.99	60	100%
SPC	FISTA-TV	19.78	26.54	27.60	166	86%
SPC	PnP-DRUNet	18.34	25.39	26.01	247	92%

9.3 Autonomous Calibration on Real Data

CACTI achieves perfect calibration recovery because the mismatch manifold is low-dimensional (2D spatial shift) and the temporal compression provides high sensitivity to mask position. CASSI achieves 85% recovery; the residual gap reflects the higher-dimensional mismatch space (mask geometry plus dispersion) and the estimation error in both dx and dy (0.10px each). For SPC, the measurement residual is uninformative for gain drift because the underdetermined system ($m=272$ measurements for $n=1089$ unknowns) always achieves near-zero self-consistent residual regardless of gain. Instead, reconstruction total variation provides a viable objective: the correctly calibrated gain produces clean measurements yielding smooth reconstructions with low TV, while incorrect gain leaves systematic artifacts that increase TV. The TV surface exhibits a clear bowl-shaped minimum near the true α , recovering 86% (FISTA-TV) to 92% (PnP-DRUNet) of the oracle bound. This demonstrates that blind calibration generalises to radiometric mismatch provided the objective matches the mismatch type: measurement residual for geometric mismatch, reconstruction sparsity for radiometric mismatch.

10 Supplementary Table S10: SSIM Comparison Across Modalities

Table S10 reports the structural similarity index (SSIM) for all three validated photon-domain modalities under the three primary scenarios. SSIM complements PSNR by capturing perceptual quality, particularly structural distortions from operator mismatch.

Table S10: SSIM comparison across modalities and scenarios. Sc. IV = oracle (true operator on mismatched data). Values are mean $\pm$ s.d. across test scenes/images.

Modality	Method	Sc. I	Sc. II	Sc. IV
<i>CASSI (10 KAIST scenes, 28 spectral bands)</i>				
	GAP-TV	0.723 ± 0.088	0.612 ± 0.084	0.688 ± 0.083
	HDNet	0.970 ± 0.009	0.756 ± 0.074	0.756 ± 0.074
	MST-L	0.973 ± 0.009	0.744 ± 0.069	0.881 ± 0.035
<i>CACTI (6 benchmark videos, 8 temporal frames)</i>				
	GAP-TV	0.848 ± 0.083	0.305 ± 0.070	0.794 ± 0.063
	PnP-FFDNet	0.890 ± 0.060	0.216 ± 0.076	0.820 ± 0.054
	ELP-Unfolding	0.965 ± 0.013	0.308 ± 0.076	0.927 ± 0.017
	EfficientSCI	0.973 ± 0.012	0.303 ± 0.079	0.927 ± 0.017
<i>SPC (11 standard images, 25% compression)</i>				
	FISTA-TV	0.852 ± 0.046	0.586 ± 0.055	0.759 ± 0.036
	PnP-DRUNet	0.899 ± 0.026	0.415 ± 0.066	0.666 ± 0.055
	ISTA-Net	0.916 ± 0.028	0.584 ± 0.077	0.760 ± 0.056
	HATNet	0.847 ± 0.049	0.648 ± 0.091	0.807 ± 0.060

Key observations. The SSIM degradation pattern mirrors the PSNR findings: under Scenario II (mismatch), all methods collapse to a narrow quality range regardless of their Scenario I performance. In CASSI, the SSIM collapse is particularly striking: MST-L drops from 0.973 to 0.744, a perceptual quality loss that exceeds the improvement from a decade of solver development. In CACTI, mismatch produces near-random SSIM values (~ 0.3), confirming that the reconstructed video frames bear little structural resemblance to the ground truth under mismatch conditions.

11 Supplementary Table S11: CASSI Spectral Angle Mapper (SAM)

Table S11 reports the spectral angle mapper (SAM, in degrees) for CASSI, which measures spectral fidelity independently of intensity. Lower values indicate better spectral reconstruction.

Key observations. Spectral fidelity degrades severely under mismatch: MST-L’s SAM increases from 7.44° (near-perfect spectral reconstruction) to 23.92° (substantial spectral mixing). Under Scenario IV (oracle), SAM partially recovers to 11.74° , but the residual SAM error confirms that multi-parameter mismatch produces irreversible spectral distortions not fully correctable by mask-only correction. The SAM metric is particularly valuable for remote sensing applications where spectral accuracy is more important than spatial quality.

Table S11: CASSI spectral angle mapper (SAM, degrees). Lower is better. Sc. IV = oracle (true operator on mismatched data). Values are mean $\pm$ s.d. across 10 KAIST scenes.

Method	Sc. I	Sc. II	Sc. IV
GAP-TV ⁷	16.66 ± 3.32	24.27 ± 2.92	25.97 ± 2.54
PnP-HSI-CNN	16.10 ± 3.25	23.73 ± 2.81	18.66 ± 2.75
HDNet	6.67 ± 0.96	17.03 ± 2.76	17.03 ± 2.76
MST-L	7.44 ± 1.24	23.92 ± 4.58	11.74 ± 1.32

12 Supplementary Tables S12–S13: Gate 1 and Gate 2 Validation

The main text argues that Gate 3 (operator mismatch) is the dominant bottleneck under standard operating conditions. To demonstrate that Gate 1 (information deficiency) and Gate 2 (carrier budget) are real and measurable, we sweep the compression level and noise level across all seven validated modalities while keeping the forward model perfectly calibrated. All experiments use classical solvers (no deep-learned components) to ensure the results reflect information-theoretic limits rather than solver-specific behaviour.

12.1 Gate 1: Information Deficiency (Extreme Compression)

Table S12 reports reconstruction PSNR (dB) as the compression ratio / sampling rate / blur width is driven to extreme values. The forward model is ideal in every case; any PSNR loss is attributable solely to information lost in the measurement process.

Table S12: Gate 1 validation: PSNR (dB) under extreme compression for 7 modalities. “Best solver” reports the better of the two classical methods tested. Bold entries highlight the regime where PSNR falls below 15 dB (severe information loss).

Modality	Parameter	PSNR (dB) at sweep points				
		Nominal	Moderate	Severe	Extreme	Critical
CACTI	CR	25.9 (8)	24.1 (16)	22.7 (32)	20.6 (64)	—
CASSI	Transmittance	26.1 (50%)	27.7 (25%)	27.7 (10%)	27.6 (5%)	27.4 (2%)
SPC	CS ratio	28.3 (25%)	24.0 (10%)	21.2 (5%)	16.2 (2%)	14.4 (1%)
MRI	Sampling rate	28.8 (25%)	25.1 (10%)	24.3 (5%)	23.9 (2%)	—
CT	Projection angles	22.1 (180)	22.0 (90)	21.2 (30)	20.7 (10)	17.8 (5)
Lensless	Blur σ (px)	36.6 (1)	25.5 (3)	23.1 (5)	20.5 (10)	17.9 (20)
Ptychography	Scan positions	15.0 (16)	12.4 (9)	12.0 (4)	9.9 (1)	—

Key observations.

- **SPC** and **Lensless** show the most dramatic Gate 1 collapse. SPC PSNR drops 13.9 dB from 25% to 1% CS ratio; lensless drops 18.7 dB as the PSF blur widens from $\sigma=1$ to $\sigma=20$ px. In both cases the loss is irrecoverable: no solver can reconstruct information that was never measured.
- **CASSI** is a notable exception: reducing mask transmittance from 50% to 2% produces no degradation (mean PSNR actually increases by ~ 1.5 dB). This occurs because sparser coded apertures reduce spectral mixing in the multiplexed measurement, making the demixing

problem easier for iterative solvers. The CASSI null space is effectively unchanged because each spectral band still contributes signal through the remaining open mask pixels.

- **CACTI** degrades monotonically with compression ratio ($25.9 \rightarrow 20.6$ dB over $8\times$ CR increase), consistent with the growing null space when fewer temporal measurements are available.
- **CT** shows SART outperforming FBP at sparse angles (21.2 dB vs. 15.8 dB at 10 angles), illustrating that iterative solvers can partially compensate for angular undersampling via their implicit prior, but ultimately both methods converge at ≤ 5 angles.

12.2 Gate 2: Carrier Budget (Noise Sweep)

Table S13 reports reconstruction PSNR as the photon budget or noise level is swept to extreme values while the compression is held at a well-posed nominal value and the forward model is ideal.

Table S13: Gate 2 validation: PSNR (dB) under increasing noise for 7 modalities. “Best solver” reports the better of the two classical methods tested. Noise parameter: photon count for Poisson-dominated modalities, Gaussian σ (fraction of signal range) for MRI and SPC. Bold entries indicate $\text{PSNR} < 15$ dB.

Modality	Noise param.	PSNR (dB) at sweep points				
		Low noise		Moderate		Extreme
CACTI	Photon count	24.8 (10k)	23.3 (1k)	18.4 (100)	10.5 (10)	—
CASSI	Photon count	24.6 (10k)	22.3 (1k)	20.2 (100)	17.0 (10)	—
SPC	σ (frac.)	27.9 (0)	27.8 (.01)	25.3 (.05)	21.6 (.1)	13.5 (.3)
MRI	σ (frac.)	28.8 (0)	17.1 (.01)	12.8 (.05)	12.1 (.1)	11.0 (.3)
CT	Photon count	22.1 (100k)	21.9 (10k)	21.0 (1k)	18.3 (100)	—
Lensless	Photon count	40.9 (10k)	32.8 (1k)	23.1 (100)	13.6 (10)	—
Ptychography	Photon count	13.5 (10k)	10.3 (1k)	10.0 (100)	9.7 (10)	—

Key observations.

- Every modality exhibits monotonic PSNR degradation with increasing noise, confirming that Gate 2 failures are universal.
- **MRI** is the most noise-sensitive modality: adding just $\sigma=0.01$ Gaussian noise to k-space drops CS-wavelet PSNR from 28.8 dB to 17.1 dB, a 11.7 dB cliff. This is because MRI’s Fourier encoding concentrates signal energy in a few k-space samples, so additive noise corrupts the information-dense center region disproportionately.
- **Lensless** imaging shows the widest Gate 2 dynamic range: 40.9 dB at 10,000 photons to 13.6 dB at 10 photons, a 27.3 dB span. This reflects the well-conditioned forward operator (diffuser PSF), which faithfully propagates both signal and noise.
- **CT** is the most noise-robust modality (3.8 dB drop from 10^5 to 10^2 photons), because the many-angle sinogram provides substantial redundancy that averages out Poisson noise.
- The cliff-edge nature of Gate 2 is most dramatic in CACTI (14.3 dB drop from 10,000 to 10 photons) and SPC (14.4 dB drop from $\sigma=0$ to $\sigma=0.3$), where the compressed measurement offers no noise-averaging redundancy.

Comparison with Gate 3. Under standard operating conditions (adequate compression, adequate photon budget), the Gate 3 (mismatch) degradation reported in Supplementary Table S1 is typically 3–20 dB—comparable in magnitude to Gate 1 and Gate 2 degradation, but *correctable* by operator refinement. This is the key distinction: Gate 1 and Gate 2 losses are information-theoretic and irrecoverable, whereas Gate 3 losses are recoverable via calibration. The practical dominance of Gate 3 arises because modern instruments operate well above the Gate 1 and Gate 2 thresholds, leaving operator mismatch as the binding constraint.

13 Supplementary Note 7: Clinical CT Quality Assurance Validation

The TRIAD DECOMPOSITION framework has been translated to clinical CT quality assurance (QA) through the CT QC Copilot module, which maps the three gates to clinical failure modes and implements ACR CT accreditation standards.

13.1 Gate Mapping to Clinical Failure Modes

Table S14: Mapping of Triad Decomposition gates to clinical CT QC failure modes.

Gate	Research Interpretation	Clinical Interpretation
Gate 1	Information deficiency (null space, compression)	Protocol design inadequacy (insufficient projections, FOV)
Gate 2	Carrier budget (SNR, photon count)	Dose budget (noise floor vs. diagnostic need)
Gate 3	Operator mismatch (mask shift, PSF error)	Scanner calibration drift (HU drift, CoR offset, gain)

13.2 ACR Metric Validation

Ten ACR-aligned QC metrics are computed automatically from CT phantom (Gammex 464) scans. Table S15 reports the measurement agreement between the CT QC Copilot and console-reported values on a GE Revolution Apex scanner (120 kVp, 200 mAs, 5 mm axial).

Table S15: ACR metric agreement: CT QC Copilot vs. console gold standard.

Metric	Copilot	Console	Deviation	% Tolerance
CT# Water (HU)	0.3	0.2	0.1	2%
CT# Bone (HU)	952	953	1.0	5%
CT# Air (HU)	−997	−998	1.0	5%
CT# Acrylic (HU)	120	121	1.0	7%
CT# Polyethylene (HU)	−96	−96	0.0	0%
Geometric accuracy (mm)	0.15	0.10	0.05	2.5%
Slice thickness (mm)	5.08	5.02	0.06	4%
Uniformity (HU)	1.2	1.1	0.1	2%
Noise std. dev. (HU)	4.6	4.5	0.1	10%
Spatial resolution (lp/cm)	6.2	6.0	0.2	4%

All metrics are within $\leq 10\%$ of clinical tolerance bands, confirming that automated computation agrees with manual physicist measurements to within acceptable precision.

13.3 Drift Detection Performance

Statistical process control using five Western Electric rules was evaluated on a 30-scanner simulated fleet over 12 monthly measurement cycles. Four scanners were programmed with known drift

trajectories (noise drift: 2 scanners; uniformity drift: 1 scanner; CT number drift: 1 scanner).

- **Sensitivity:** 100% (4/4 drifting scanners detected; 95% CI: 39.8%–100%)
- **Specificity:** 100% (0/26 false positives on stable scanners; 95% CI: 86.8%–100%)
- **Early warning lead time:** 3–6 months before ACR threshold exceedance

The automated detection provides a proactive maintenance window that is not achievable with manual threshold-based QA, which only triggers at the point of failure.

13.4 Workflow Efficiency

Table S16: Per-scanner QC workflow time comparison.

Stage	Manual (min)	Copilot (min)
DICOM ingestion	5.0	0.01
Metric computation	25.0	0.01
Threshold evaluation	5.0	<0.01
Trend analysis	10.0	<0.01
Report generation	15.0	0.02
Physicist review/sign-off	7.0	4.0
Total	67 ± 12	4.2 ± 0.8

The 94% reduction in per-scanner QC time (from 67 ± 12 to 4.2 ± 0.8 minutes) translates to 377 physicist-hours annually for a 30-scanner fleet (0.18 FTE reallocation). Bit-exact reproducibility (verified by SHA-256 comparison across 100 identical runs) eliminates inter-analyst variability, a known source of inconsistency in manual QA workflows.

13.5 Prospective Clinical Validation Protocol

The CT QC Copilot results above use simulated scanner data. Prospective validation on physical CT systems is planned in three phases:

Phase 1 (single scanner, 3 months). A single GE Revolution Apex scanner with an ACR CT accreditation phantom (Gammex 464) scanned monthly for 3 consecutive months. Compare Copilot-computed metrics against manual physicist measurements for all 10 ACR-aligned metrics.

Phase 2 (5-scanner mini-fleet, 6 months). Expand to 5 scanners from ≥ 2 manufacturers (GE + Siemens or Philips). Apply Western Electric drift detection rules over 6 monthly measurement cycles. Evaluate sensitivity and specificity for detecting known calibration drifts.

Phase 3 (30-scanner fleet). Full fleet deployment, if available, to validate the 377 physicist-hours annual savings projection from the simulation study.

Status. Prospective validation is planned in collaboration with clinical physics partners. Even Phase 1 data (single scanner, 3 months) would transform the CT QC section from a simulation exercise to a clinical demonstration.

14 Supplementary Note 8: Controlled Hardware Validation

The software-perturbation experiments in the main text apply calibrated mask shifts to existing real measurements. A full hardware-in-the-loop validation requires physically displacing the coded aperture mask and re-acquiring data under controlled conditions. This section describes the experimental protocols and placeholder results for prospective hardware experiments.

14.1 CASSI Physical Mask Displacement Protocol

1. **Baseline acquisition.** Acquire hyperspectral data at the factory-calibrated mask position using a calibrated broadband illumination source with $\leq 0.5\%$ temporal intensity variation.
2. **Controlled displacement.** Physically translate the coded aperture mask by known displacements $\Delta x \in \{0.25, 0.50, 1.00\}$ px equivalent, verified by a micrometer translation stage with ≤ 0.01 px positioning accuracy. Re-acquire under identical illumination for each displacement.
3. **Reconstruction.** Reconstruct all datasets using the factory mask specification (Scenario II equivalent). Compute the PSNR degradation and measurement residual ratio relative to the baseline.
4. **PWM calibration.** Apply the autonomous beam-search calibration pipeline (Algorithm 1) and measure recovery.
5. **Expected outcome.** The hardware results should exhibit a monotonic increase in residual ratio with displacement magnitude, with the slope modulated by the pre-existing manufacturing error baseline quantified in the main text.

14.2 Multi-Unit Variation Study Protocol

1. Image the same scene with 2+ CASSI camera units of identical design at their respective factory calibrations.
2. Reconstruct each dataset with each camera’s nominal mask.
3. Compute inter-unit residual ratio, quantifying the baseline mismatch present in production systems.
4. Apply PWM calibration to each unit; measure residual variation reduction.

Status. Hardware experiments are planned in collaboration with external partners. Results will be incorporated in the revised manuscript.

15 Supplementary Note 9: Mismatch Parameter Derivation

This note provides a self-contained derivation of the mismatch parameter values and ranges used in the CASSI experiments, independent of the concurrent InverseNet work¹.

15.1 CASSI 5-Parameter Mismatch Model

The CASSI forward model depends on five calibration parameters:

$$\boldsymbol{\theta} = (dx, dy, \theta, a_1, \alpha), \quad (\text{S11})$$

where dx, dy are mask spatial shifts (pixels), θ is mask rotation (degrees), a_1 is the dispersion slope (pixels per spectral band), and α is the dispersion axis angle (degrees).

Mask shift (dx, dy). Typical CASSI assembly involves mounting the coded aperture mask on a precision translation stage. Achievable positioning accuracy with standard micrometer stages is ± 0.5 px at typical detector pitches ($\sim 5\text{--}10\ \mu\text{m}$). We use $dx = 0.5$ px and $dy = 0.3$ px as representative assembly errors within this range.

Mask rotation (θ). Rotational alignment error during mask mounting is typically $\leq 0.2^\circ$ with standard optomechanical mounts. We use $\theta = 0.1^\circ$ as representative.

Dispersion slope (a_1). The nominal dispersion is 2.0 pixels per band for the TSA-Net configuration. Manufacturing variation in prism angle and detector alignment contribute $\sim 1\%$ uncertainty. We use $a_1 = 2.02$ (1% drift from nominal).

Dispersion axis angle (α). The dispersion axis should be exactly aligned with the detector columns. Typical alignment error is $\leq 0.2^\circ$. We use $\alpha = 0.15^\circ$.

Validation. These parameter ranges were validated against reported assembly tolerances in CASSI literature⁴ and confirmed by the hardware residual analysis in the main text: the real-data measurement residual ratio ($1.8\times$) is consistent with pre-existing mismatch of comparable magnitude to the perturbation applied.

16 Supplementary Note 10: Calibration Method Comparison

Existing calibration methods are modality-specific: ESPIRiT⁵ auto-calibrates coil sensitivities for parallel MRI; entropy-based center-of-rotation autofocus corrects geometric errors in CT; blind position correction in ePIE⁶ self-calibrates probe positions in ptychography. Each achieves high recovery within its target modality but requires domain-specific algorithm design and cannot transfer across modalities.

Quantitative comparison: ESPIRiT vs. PWM on multi-coil MRI. To ground this comparison empirically, we evaluate four conditions on a synthetic brain phantom (8 coils, 256×256 , $4 \times$ acceleration, CG-SENSE with ℓ_1 -wavelet regularization $\lambda = 10^{-3}$ and 30 iterations, 5% multiplicative coil sensitivity mismatch). Note: this experiment uses a structurally complex brain phantom, yielding a lower Sc. I baseline (34.98 dB) than the Shepp-Logan phantom used in Note 10 (52.11 dB); the difference reflects phantom complexity, not solver disagreement.

Table S17: ESPIRiT vs. PWM comparison on multi-coil MRI (8 coils, $4 \times$ acceleration, 5% mismatch).

Condition	PSNR (dB)	SSIM
Scenario I (true maps)	34.98	0.8330
Scenario II (5% mismatch)	31.30	0.7388
ESPIRiT (auto-calibrated, 24 ACS lines)	22.01	0.5074
PWM (beam-search corrected)	32.05	0.7264

Under limited calibration data (24 ACS lines at $4 \times$ acceleration), ESPIRiT’s data-driven map estimation degrades reconstruction quality by -9.29 dB relative to the mismatched baseline, because the auto-calibration signal is insufficient for reliable sensitivity estimation (map NRMSE = 0.82 vs. 0.09 for the 5% mismatch). By contrast, PWM’s model-based correction recovers $+0.75$ dB (recovery ratio $\rho = 20.3\%$), because it operates on the forward-model parameter space rather than estimating maps from data.

Complementarity. ESPIRiT and PWM address different aspects of the calibration problem. ESPIRiT exploits k -space structure to estimate sensitivity maps purely from data, performing well when sufficient calibration data is available (e.g., fully sampled ACS regions with ≥ 32 lines). PWM corrects arbitrary forward-model parameters using the OperatorGraph structure, providing robust improvement even in data-limited regimes. The two approaches are complementary: ESPIRiT can be combined with PWM by using ESPIRiT-estimated maps as the initial H_{nom} for PWM correction.

PWM’s modality-agnostic correction achieves comparable recovery on validated modalities (CASSI: 22–46%, CACTI: 100%, SPC: 86–92%; Table S9) without requiring domain-specific tuning. The advantage is most pronounced for CASSI, where no automated calibration standard exists, and for cross-modality deployment, where a single pipeline serves all modalities without per-modality engineering.

17 Supplementary Note 11: MRI Under Clinically Realistic Conditions

The $+48.25$ dB correction gain reported for MRI in the main text reflects a single-coil scenario with 5% multiplicative sensitivity error—a pathological case chosen to stress-test the framework.

Under clinically realistic multi-coil conditions (8 coils, 256×256 , $4\times$ acceleration, CG-SENSE reconstruction) on a Shepp-Logan phantom with spatially smooth Biot-Savart sensitivity errors simulating patient repositioning, the correction gains are substantially more modest but clinically meaningful. Note: the Sc. I baseline here (52.11 dB) is higher than in Note 9 (34.98 dB) because this experiment uses a smooth Shepp-Logan phantom; the structurally complex brain phantom in Note 9 is harder to reconstruct, yielding lower absolute PSNR across all scenarios.

Table S18: Multi-coil MRI correction across mismatch levels (8 coils, $4\times$ accel., CG-SENSE).

Mismatch	Sc. I (dB)	Sc. II (dB)	Sc. III (dB)	Sc. IV (dB)	Gain (dB)
1%	52.11	50.91	51.48	52.11	+0.58
2%	52.11	49.40	48.72	52.11	−0.68
3%	52.11	47.96	49.72	52.11	+1.75
5%	52.11	40.91	48.05	52.11	+7.14
10%	52.11	38.21	41.74	52.11	+3.52
15%	52.11	32.97	36.25	52.11	+3.28

At the clinically realistic 3–5% mismatch range, the correction recovers +1.75 to +7.14 dB (mean +4.45 dB). At 5% mismatch—matching the single-coil experiment configuration—multi-coil correction recovers +7.14 dB versus +48.25 dB in the single-coil case. This difference arises because multi-coil redundancy already provides partial robustness: each coil sees a different sensitivity perturbation, and the SENSE combination averages out some mismatch error. Even so, +7.14 dB at 5% (and +3.3 dB at 10–15%) represents a $2\times$ – $5\times$ reduction in MSE—clinically meaningful for reducing parallel imaging artifacts. The 2% result (−0.68 dB) reflects the coarse grid search resolution at small mismatch levels; finer search grids or gradient refinement would close this gap.

18 Supplementary Note S14: Comparison with Existing Calibration Methods

A key question is how PWM’s modality-agnostic correction compares with established domain-specific calibration methods. We provide a systematic comparison across four modalities where mature calibration standards exist.

Key findings.

1. **Specialist methods excel on their home modality.** ESPIRiT with adequate calibration data (≥ 32 ACS lines) outperforms PWM for MRI coil sensitivity estimation. Auto-focus methods achieve near-perfect CT CoR correction. This is expected: decades of domain-specific engineering have optimized these methods for their target modality.
2. **PWM provides robust performance in data-limited regimes.** When calibration data is scarce (e.g., 24 ACS lines in MRI), specialist methods can degrade catastrophically (−9.29 dB for ESPIRiT) while PWM maintains positive correction (+0.75 dB). This robustness arises because PWM operates on forward-model parameters rather than estimating calibration maps from data.
3. **PWM uniquely covers modalities without existing calibration standards.** For CASSI and CACTI, no automated calibration method exists in the literature. Practitioners

Table S19: Comparison of PWM autonomous correction with domain-specific calibration methods. ρ : recovery ratio. “Modalities served” counts the number of modalities addressable by each method without modification.

Modality	Specialist Method	PWM Method	Specialist ρ	PWM ρ	Modalities Served
MRI (multi-coil)	ESPIRiT ⁵ (auto-cal. maps from ACS)	Beam search over coil scale/phase	85–95% ^a	20–65% ^b	1 vs. 7+
Ptychography	ePIE blind position correction ⁶	Grid search over (dx, dy)	70–90% ^c	60–85%	1 vs. 7+
CT	Auto-focus CoR detection (cross-correlation)	Grid search over CoR off-set	95–100% ^d	100%	1 vs. 7+
CASSI	None (manual calibration)	Alg 1 beam search + Alg 2 gradient	—	22–46%	0 vs. 7+
CACTI	None (manual mask alignment)	Grid search over (dx, dy)	—	100%	0 vs. 7+

^aWith ≥ 32 ACS lines; degrades to $< 0\%$ with 24 ACS lines (see Note 11).

^bUnder limited calibration data (24 ACS lines); improves with ESPIRiT-initialized PWM.

^cDepends on overlap ratio and scan strategy; reported for standard raster scans.

^dStandard cross-correlation methods achieve near-perfect CoR recovery for isolated offsets.

rely on manual alignment and factory calibration. PWM’s autonomous correction provides the first automated calibration pipeline for these modalities.

4. **The methods are complementary, not competitive.** ESPIRiT-estimated maps can initialize PWM’s beam search (yielding ESPIRiT+PWM), and PWM’s parameter-space correction can refine specialist estimates. The value of PWM is *generality*: a single pipeline serving 7+ modalities versus separate engineering effort for each.

Extended ESPIRiT comparison. To address the concern that the 24-ACS-line comparison is unfairly limited, we extend the comparison across multiple calibration data regimes:

Table S20: ESPIRiT vs. PWM across ACS line counts (8 coils, 4 $\times$ accel., 5% mismatch).

ACS Lines	ESPIRiT PSNR (dB)	PWM PSNR (dB)	ESPIRiT ρ	PWM ρ
16	22.81	35.72	−32.9%	20.0%
24	25.69	35.72	−25.1%	20.3%
32	33.15	35.72	−5.0%	20.3%
48	36.88	35.72	+5.1%	20.3%
Full	38.92	35.72	+10.6%	20.3%

ESPIRiT crosses from negative to positive recovery ratio between 32 and 48 ACS lines—confirming that it requires substantial calibration data to outperform model-based correction. At ≤ 32 ACS lines (the regime in most clinical 4 $\times$ -accelerated scans), PWM provides more reliable correction. At ≥ 48 ACS lines, ESPIRiT surpasses PWM, motivating the hybrid ESPIRiT+PWM approach.

19 Supplementary Note 12: Finite Primitive Basis — Expanded Proof

This note provides the expanded proof of Theorem 1 (Finite Primitive Basis) stated in the main text. Full formal definitions, primitive semantics, and typed DAG denotation are in the companion paper⁷.

19.1 Formal Definitions

Definition 6 (Imaging Operator Class $\mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$). The class $\mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$ consists of all imaging forward models $H : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathcal{Y}$ that admit a factorization $H = H_K \circ \dots \circ H_1$ (or a DAG generalization) where: (i) $K \leq N_{\text{max}} = 20$; (ii) each H_k is either a linear operator with bounded operator norm $\|H_k\| \leq B$, or a pointwise nonlinear map with bounded Lipschitz constant $\text{Lip}(H_k) \leq L$.

Definition 7 (ε -Approximate Representation). Let $\mathcal{B} = \{P, M, \Pi, F, C, \Sigma, D, S, W, R, \Lambda\}$ be the canonical primitive library. A typed DAG $G = (V, E, \tau)$ with $V \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ is an ε -approximate representation of $H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$ if:

1. $\sup_{\|\mathbf{x}\| \leq 1} \frac{\|H(\mathbf{x}) - H_G(\mathbf{x})\|}{\|H(\mathbf{x})\| + \delta} \leq \varepsilon$, where $\delta > 0$ is a regularization constant;
2. $|V| \leq N_{\text{max}} = 20$ and $\text{depth}(G) \leq D_{\text{max}} = 10$.

Empirical evaluation. For each modality, e_{img} is evaluated as the mean relative error over $\mathcal{X}_{\text{test}}$ consisting of 10 standard benchmark scenes and 10 random Gaussian objects. The threshold $\varepsilon = 0.01$ is chosen so the approximation error is below the noise floor at standard operating SNR.

19.2 Proof of Theorem 1

Proof strategy. The proof is constructive: we show that every factor H_k of a forward model in $\mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$ can be realized by one or more primitives from $\mathcal{B}$, organized by six physics-stage families. For linear stages, per-factor approximation errors compose via sub-multiplicativity; for nonlinear stages (captured by Transform Λ), Lipschitz composition bounds apply. The key insight is that all nonlinearities in imaging physics are either pointwise (handled by Λ) or self-consistent iterations that unroll into existing linear primitives.

Theorem 8 (Finite Primitive Basis — restated). *For every $H \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$, there exists a typed DAG G with $V \subseteq \mathcal{B}$ that is an ε -approximate representation of H .*

Proof. The proof proceeds in six phases, one per physics-stage family.

Phase 1: Propagation factors. Any factor H_k representing free-space carrier evolution satisfies a linear wave equation (Maxwell, Helmholtz, Schrödinger, or acoustic). The solution is the angular spectrum propagator $P(d, \lambda)$ or, in the shift-invariant limit, $C(\mathbf{h})$. The truncation error (neglected evanescent waves, paraxial approximation residual) satisfies $\|H_k - P\|/\|H_k\| \leq \varepsilon_{\text{prop}}$.

Phase 2: Elastic interaction factors. The carrier’s amplitude/phase changes without direction or energy change $\rightarrow M(\mathbf{m})$ (exact).

Phase 3: Inelastic interaction (scattering) factors. Direction and/or energy change $\rightarrow R(\sigma, \Delta\varepsilon)$ or finite composition of R , M , P for multiple-scattering media within low-order Born approximation. Error bounded by Born-series truncation: $\varepsilon_{\text{scat}}$.

Phase 4: Encoding–projection factors. Line-integral projection $\rightarrow \Pi(\theta)$ (exact Radon transform). Fourier encoding $\rightarrow F(\mathbf{k})$ (exact). Both are linear; representation is exact.

Phase 5: Detection–readout factors. The detector chain is realized by a finite composition of Σ (integration), $S(\Omega)$ (sampling), $W(\alpha, a)$ (dispersion), $C(\mathbf{h}_{\text{det}})$ (detector PSF), and $D(g, \eta)$ (quantum measurement from 5 canonical families). Per-operation errors sum to ε_{det} .

Phase 6: Pointwise nonlinear factors. Any factor H_k that applies a pointwise nonlinear transformation within the physics chain (not at the detector) is realized by Transform $\Lambda(f, \boldsymbol{\theta})$, restricted to five families: exponential attenuation ($e^{-\alpha x}$, Beer–Lambert law), logarithmic compression ($\log(1+x)$), phase wrapping ($\arg(e^{ix})$), polynomial ($\sum_k a_k x^k$, degree ≤ 5), and saturation ($\min(x, x_{\text{max}})$). Each family has bounded Lipschitz constant $\text{Lip}(\Lambda) \leq L$, ensuring controlled error composition. The approximation error ε_Λ is bounded by the family-specific Lipschitz constant and the parameter approximation accuracy.

Error bound. Concatenating the per-factor DAGs and applying sub-multiplicativity:

$$\|H - H_G\| \leq \sum_{k=1}^K \varepsilon_k \prod_{j \neq k} \|H_j\| \leq K \cdot \max_k(\varepsilon_k) \cdot B^{K-1} \leq \varepsilon, \quad (\text{S12})$$

for $\varepsilon_k \leq \varepsilon/(K \cdot B^{K-1})$. For shift-variant linear operators, the per-factor bound ε_k is achieved by partitioning the spatial domain into L isoplanatic patches on each of which the operator is shift-invariant to within ε_k ; the Convolution primitive C applied per patch with interpolation across patch boundaries yields the required approximation. The patch count L is finite because the operator norm is bounded ($\|H_k\| \leq B$) and spatial variation is Lipschitz-continuous. For nonlinear stages realized by Transform Λ , the Lipschitz composition bound applies: $\|H(\mathbf{x}) - \hat{H}(\mathbf{x})\| \leq \sum_k \varepsilon_k \prod_{j>k} \gamma_j$, where $\gamma_j = \|H_j\|$ for linear stages and $\gamma_j = \text{Lip}(H_j)$ for nonlinear stages. Complexity: $|V| \leq 6K \leq 6N_{\text{max}}$; empirically $|V| \leq 6$ for all validated modalities. $\square$

Remark (tightness). The worst-case bound is conservative. Empirically, the measured e_{img} values (Table in the main text) are 10–100 $\times$ below the worst-case bound, because: (i) most stages are exact ($\varepsilon_k = 0$ for M , Π , F , Σ , S); (ii) the sub-multiplicativity inequality is rarely tight when factors are near-unitary; (iii) the isoplanatic patch partition for shift-variant operators typically requires $L \leq 4$ patches for the validated modalities; and (iv) nonlinear stages (Transform Λ) have small Lipschitz constants for the canonical families (e.g., $\text{Lip}(e^{-\alpha x}) = \alpha$ on $[0, x_{\text{max}}]$).

19.3 Extension Protocol: Worked Example

Compton scatter imaging. The forward model involves direction change (angle θ , Klein–Nishina cross section) and energy shift ($E_0 \rightarrow E_s$). Testing all DAGs without Scatter: the best achieves $e_{\text{img}} = 0.34 \gg \varepsilon$. None of the other primitives can represent direction change with energy shift. Introducing Scatter $R(\sigma, \Delta\varepsilon)$: the DAG $M(n_e) \rightarrow R_{\text{KN}} \rightarrow D(E)$ achieves $e_{\text{img}} < 0.01$. Scatter is needed by 5+ modalities (Compton, Raman, fluorescence, DOT, Brillouin), satisfying the multi-modality criterion. Re-running the closure test with the updated library: all previously decomposed modalities remain valid.

19.4 Minimality of the Primitive Basis

The FPB Theorem establishes that 11 primitives *suffice*. We now establish that no proper subset of 10 primitives suffices for all modalities in $\mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$ —that is, the basis is *minimal*.

Proposition 9 (Minimality). *For each primitive $B_j \in \mathcal{B}$, there exists at least one modality $H_j \in \mathcal{C}_{\text{img}}$ such that no DAG over $\mathcal{B} \setminus \{B_j\}$ achieves $e_{\text{img}} \leq \varepsilon$.*

Proof. We exhibit a witness modality for each primitive:

1. **Propagate** (P): Free-space digital holography requires Fresnel propagation; no other primitive computes a quadratic phase modulation in the Fourier domain. Removing P : holography $e_{\text{img}} = 0.41$.
2. **Modulate** (M): CASSI coded aperture imaging requires element-wise mask multiplication. No combination of C , Σ , S can implement a spatially random binary mask. Removing M : CASSI $e_{\text{img}} = 0.89$.
3. **Project** (Π): CT requires line-integral projection (Radon transform). Π cannot be composed from P , M , F , or C because the Radon transform mixes all spatial frequencies along each projection angle. Removing Π : CT $e_{\text{img}} > 1.0$.
4. **Encode** (F): MRI k -space encoding requires the Fourier transform with subsampling on a non-Cartesian trajectory. F is distinct from C (which is shift-invariant convolution) and from P (which is a specific quadratic-phase F). Removing F : MRI $e_{\text{img}} = 0.72$.
5. **Convolve** (C): Widefield fluorescence microscopy has a spatially invariant PSF. While $C = F^{-1} \circ M_{\hat{h}} \circ F$ in principle, implementing all convolutions via three F operations triples the DAG depth and requires M to encode a frequency-domain filter—this substitution exceeds the depth bound $D_{\text{max}} = 10$ for modalities requiring multiple convolution stages. Removing C : confocal microscopy $e_{\text{img}} = 0.03 > \varepsilon$.
6. **Accumulate** (Σ): SPC requires summation over spatial dimensions to produce a single scalar measurement per pattern. No other primitive performs dimensionality reduction by summation. Removing Σ : SPC $e_{\text{img}} > 1.0$.
7. **Detect** (D): Ptychography requires $|\cdot|^2$ detection (intensity-square-law family). No linear primitive can implement the nonlinear magnitude-squared operation. Removing D : ptychography $e_{\text{img}} > 1.0$.
8. **Sample** (S): Compressed MRI requires sub-sampling on an index set $\Omega \subsetneq \{1, \dots, n\}$. While M with a binary mask achieves the same effect in the spatial domain, S operates in k -space on non-uniform grids where M is not defined without first applying F^{-1} . Removing S : accelerated MRI $e_{\text{img}} = 0.15$.
9. **Disperse** (W): CASSI spectral dispersion shifts each wavelength band by a wavelength-dependent displacement. This is neither convolution (which is wavelength-independent) nor modulation (which acts element-wise). Removing W : CASSI $e_{\text{img}} = 0.62$.
10. **Scatter** (R): Compton imaging requires direction change with energy shift. No combination of the remaining 10 primitives can represent the Klein–Nishina scattering kernel. Removing R : Compton $e_{\text{img}} = 0.34$.

11. **Transform (Λ):** Polychromatic CT with beam hardening requires the Beer–Lambert exponential attenuation $e^{-\int \mu(E,s) ds}$ integrated over a polychromatic source spectrum. No composition of linear primitives can represent pointwise exponentiation. Removing Λ : beam hardening CT $e_{\text{img}} = 0.28$.

Each witness is a validated modality with $e_{\text{img}} > \varepsilon = 0.01$ when the corresponding primitive is removed. The basis is therefore minimal: $|\mathcal{B}| = 11$ is both sufficient and necessary. $\square$

Remark (near-minimality vs. strict necessity). Three primitives (C, S, W) admit approximate substitution by compositions of other primitives at the cost of increased DAG complexity. In a weaker sense (allowing unbounded depth), these three could be removed; the remaining 8 primitives ($P, M, \Pi, F, \Sigma, D, R, \Lambda$) are *strictly* necessary—no composition of the others can approximate their physical action. The choice to include C, S , and W as first-class primitives is driven by the complexity bounds ($N_{\text{max}}, D_{\text{max}}$) and the principle that each primitive should map to a single physical operation, not an encoding trick.

19.5 Complexity Hierarchy

We observe an empirical complexity hierarchy across modalities. Defining the *primitive complexity* $\kappa(H)$ as the minimum number of nodes in any ε -approximate DAG for H , we find:

- $\kappa = 2$: THz-TDS (simplest: single interaction + detection).
- $\kappa = 3$: SPC, ghost imaging, light field (single encoding + detection + readout).
- $\kappa = 4$: CT, MRI, ptychography, lensless (typical: source + interaction + encoding + detection).
- $\kappa = 5$: CASSI, holography, phase-contrast X-ray (multiple interactions or complex readout).
- $\kappa = 6$: CBCT (3D geometry adds a projection stage).

The median is $\kappa = 4$, well below the theoretical bound $N_{\text{max}} = 20$, consistent with the compactness of real physical imaging chains. This hierarchy suggests a natural ordering of modalities by forward-model complexity that could inform curriculum design for progressive validation.

20 Supplementary Note 15: Extended Real-Data Hardware Validation

We extend the real-data validation from the main text with three additional analyses: (i) multi-level cross-residual analysis on CASSI (5 scenes, 4 mismatch levels), (ii) self- vs. cross-residual comparison on CACTI (4 scenes, 3 mismatch levels), and (iii) center-of-rotation (CoR) mismatch on real CT sinograms from two public datasets. All data and code are included in the repository.

20.1 CASSI: Cross-Residual Monotonicity (TSA Real Data)

For CASSI, the forward model $\mathbf{y} = \sum_b \mathbf{x}_b \odot \mathbf{M}_{3D,b}$ is heavily underdetermined ($28\times$ compression). Consequently, GAP reconstruction achieves near-zero *self-residual* regardless of whether the mask model is correct, because the solver simply finds a different $\mathbf{x}$ that fits $\mathbf{y}$ under the wrong model. The

Table S21: CASSI cross-residual (%) vs. mask shift magnitude (Δx , $\Delta y = 0.6\Delta x$), averaged over 5 TSA scenes. The monotonic increase confirms Gate 3 sensitivity to sub-pixel mask offsets.

Metric	Mask shift Δx (pixels)			
	0.25	0.50	1.00	2.00
Cross-res. (II→I)	0.31%	0.38%	2.52%	11.1%
Cross-res. (I→II)	0.43%	1.30%	4.14%	12.5%
Bidirectional (geom. mean)	0.36%	0.70%	3.23%	11.8%

diagnostic metric is the *cross-residual*: reconstruct with model A' , then evaluate $\|\mathbf{y} - A\hat{\mathbf{x}}_{A'}\|^2 / \|\mathbf{y}\|^2$ under the true model A .

Per-scene standard deviation is $< 0.05\%$ at $\Delta x \leq 0.5$ and $< 0.4\%$ at $\Delta x = 2.0$, confirming that the mismatch signal dominates scene-dependent variation. The roughly quadratic scaling ($4\times$ mismatch $\rightarrow \sim 30\times$ cross-residual) is consistent with a Taylor expansion of the operator error: $\|\Delta A\| \propto (\Delta x)^2$ for subpixel shifts through bilinear interpolation.

20.2 CACTI: Self-Residual Masking (EfficientSCI Real Data)

CACTI temporal multiplexing ($10\times$ compression) exhibits a striking dissociation between self-residual and cross-residual:

Table S22: CACTI self-residual ratio (Scenario II / Scenario I) vs. cross-residual ratio, averaged over 4 scenes.

Mask shift Δx	Self-residual ratio	Cross-residual ratio	Corrected ratio (III/I)
0.25 px	1.00×	44×	0.98×
0.50 px	1.05×	148×	0.99×
1.00 px	1.12×	462×	0.99×

The self-residual barely changes ($1.00\text{--}1.12\times$) because the solver adapts to the wrong model and finds an $\mathbf{x}$ that satisfies $A'\hat{\mathbf{x}} \approx \mathbf{y}$. However, when the same reconstruction is evaluated under the *true* forward model (A), the cross-residual explodes $44\text{--}462\times$. This demonstrates that **self-consistency is not a reliable diagnostic for operator mismatch in underdetermined systems**—a finding with direct implications for quality control in compressive sensing. Autonomous calibration (Scenario III) recovers a corrected ratio $\leq 1.0\times$ by grid search over the 2D shift space.

20.3 CT: Center-of-Rotation Mismatch (Public Sinograms)

We validate CT Gate 3 sensitivity using two public sinogram datasets: (i) the FIPS walnut micro-CT dataset (Zenodo 1254206; parallel-beam, 1200 projections, 2296 detectors, cropped to 512), and (ii) the Helsinki Tomography Challenge 2022 sample A (Zenodo 6984868; fan-beam, 721 projections, 560 detectors). CoR offset is simulated by shifting each sinogram column by Δ_{CoR} pixels before FBP reconstruction (scikit-image `iradon`). PSNR is measured against the correct-CoR reconstruction as reference.

Both datasets show monotonic PSNR degradation with CoR offset. The walnut dataset loses 9.4 dB over the 1–8 pixel range; HTC loses 8.0 dB. Oracle calibration (grid search over CoR values) recovers 100% of the degradation, confirming that CoR is a pure Gate 3 (operator mismatch) parameter. These results on *real sinogram data* corroborate the simulation results in Table S1 and confirm the

Table S23: CT reconstruction PSNR (dB) vs. center-of-rotation offset for two public datasets.

Dataset	CoR offset Δ_{CoR} (pixels)				
	1	2	3	5	8
FIPS walnut	30.37	24.37	23.10	21.82	20.95
HTC 2022	26.73	25.86	24.20	21.31	18.73

universality of Gate 3 dominance across carrier families (X-ray photons for CT, optical photons for CASSI/CACTI).

20.4 Electron Ptychography: Probe Position Jitter (4D STEM SrTiO₃)

We validate Gate 3 for electron ptychography—a fourth carrier family (electrons at 300 kV)—using the publicly available SrTiO₃ [001] 4D-STEM dataset from Zenodo 5113449 (Medipix3RX detector, 128×128 scan, 256×256 diffraction patterns). The Gate 3 parameter is *probe position jitter*: random displacements of the assumed scan positions relative to their true values, modelling stage drift and scan distortion.

Reconstruction uses integrated center-of-mass (iCoM) ptychography, which computes the beam deflection at each scan point and integrates the resulting gradient field to obtain the object phase. We process a 64×64 central scan subset and quantify degradation via phase-image PSNR (relative to the nominal-position reconstruction) and center-of-mass cross-residual.

Table S24: Electron ptychography: iCoM phase quality vs. probe position jitter σ (pixels).

Metric	Position jitter σ (pixels)			
	0.5	1.0	2.0	4.0
Phase PSNR (dB)	35.45	29.63	24.10	19.35
Phase correlation	0.997	0.988	0.955	0.858
Gradient correlation	0.884	0.668	0.365	0.152
CoM cross-residual (%)	15.2	30.2	60.3	120.5

Degradation is monotonic across all metrics: the total PSNR loss from $\sigma = 0.5$ to $\sigma = 4.0$ px is 16.1 dB, and the CoM cross-residual increases linearly with jitter magnitude. Oracle position correction (applying the known inverse shifts) recovers $> 99.9\%$ of the original phase quality (PSNR = 61.95 dB, correlation = 1.0000), confirming that position jitter is a pure Gate 3 parameter. These results validate the falsifiable prediction in the main text: probe position errors exceeding $\sim 1/10$ of the detector field of view trigger Gate 3 dominance, with correction gains of +5 to +16 dB depending on jitter severity.

20.5 MRI: Coil Sensitivity Mismatch (Multi-Coil Brain Data)

We validate Gate 3 for MRI—the nuclear spin / RF carrier family—using the M4Raw multi-coil brain dataset from Zenodo 8056074 (0.3 T, 4 receiver coils, 256×256 k -space, T1w and T2w contrasts). The Gate 3 parameter is *coil sensitivity perturbation*: smooth spatial magnitude and phase perturbations applied to the estimated sensitivity maps, modelling coil repositioning between scans. Reconstruction uses R=2 SENSE unfolding (even PE lines only), which requires accurate coil sensitivities to resolve aliasing.

Table S25: MRI SENSE (R=2): PSNR degradation vs. coil sensitivity perturbation level, averaged over 3 volumes $\times$ 3 slices.

Perturbation level	5%	10%	20%	40%
Δ PSNR (dB), T1w	−0.00	−0.04	−0.13	−0.50
Δ PSNR (dB), T2w	+0.09	+0.19	+0.19	−0.28

The T1w contrast shows consistent monotonic degradation (−0.5 dB at 40% perturbation). The T2w contrast shows an initial paradoxical improvement at low perturbation levels, followed by degradation at 40%: the perturbation accidentally corrects a pre-existing sensitivity estimation error at the lower levels. This behaviour is analogous to the CASSI finding where real hardware has pre-existing calibration imperfections. Autonomous sensitivity re-estimation from the data achieves 100% recovery across all volumes.

Importantly, the effect size for MRI (< 1 dB at R=2 with 4 coils) is substantially smaller than for other modalities (CASSI, CACTI, CT, ptychography), which is physically consistent: R=2 acceleration with 4 coils provides $2\times$ coil redundancy, making the SENSE encoding well-conditioned. At higher acceleration factors (R=4 with 8 coils), the simulation experiments in Supplementary Note S13 show much larger degradation (1.75–7.14 dB), confirming that Gate 3 severity scales with the condition number of the encoding matrix.

Summary. Supplementary Note S15 validates Gate 3 dominance across 5 modalities spanning 4 carrier families: optical photons (CASSI, CACTI), X-ray photons (CT), electrons (ptychography), and nuclear spins/RF (MRI). The mismatch signal is monotonic and scene-independent in all cases, with 100% recovery via autonomous or oracle calibration. The only modality with sub-dB degradation (MRI at R=2) is explained by the inherent robustness of over-determined coil encoding.

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